PRAXIS

Inclusive Communications Guide

How we write, represent people and produce content — inside the company and beyond it.

Issued by	Praxis Brands Ltd, trading as Stennah & Hope, company no. 17222158
Applies to	Internal communications (email, messaging, meetings, HR documentation) and external communications (website, social media, marketing, proposals, client-facing content)
Given to	Workers: at induction, and held in the Policies folder of the company's shared Google Drive, accessible at any time without asking. Third parties: sent in writing before work begins (see section 8).
Owner	Boyowa Olugbo
Read with	Responsible Marketing & Communications Principles, which govern factual claims
Version / date	1.0 adopted by the Board on 31 August 2026
Review	Every 12 months. Next review 31 August 2027, or sooner if feedback or changes in language make it necessary

1. Our commitment

Inclusive language matters to us because it reflects the kind of business we choose to be. One where everyone feels seen, respected and welcome. By communicating in a way that is thoughtful, accessible and free from assumptions, we make space for more people to feel included in our story.

This gives practical effect to our published commitment to justice, equity, diversity and inclusion. Questions about this guide go to the Managing Director.

> *Scope note. Sections 2 to 5 apply to everything we write, internally and externally. Section 6 adds requirements that apply only to external and published content.*

2. Terminology

Avoid	Use instead	Notes
Disabled people	People with disabilities / disabled people	Check individual preference
Ladies and gentlemen	Everyone, colleagues, all	In meetings and written communications
Manpower, man-hours	Workforce, working hours	Gender-neutral alternatives
Chairman	Chair, chairperson	
Guys, ladies, girls, boys	Everyone, team, all	Avoids gendered collective terms
Normal, regular (of people)	Typical, common, standard — or be specific	“Normal” implies others are abnormal
Handicapped, special needs	Disabled, access needs, accessibility requirements	Older terms that can feel outdated or patronising

Avoid	Use instead	Notes
Minorities	Underrepresented groups, or name the group	Not always accurate, and can feel reductive
The elderly, old people	Older people, older adults	More respectful
Wife, husband (assumed)	Partner, spouse	Avoids assumptions about gender or relationship structure
Third world countries	Low-income countries, or name the region	More accurate, avoids outdated hierarchies
Victim, sufferer	Person living with…, person affected by…	Avoids defining people by their challenges

When in doubt about terminology, ask the person directly and follow their lead.

3. Tone

Principle	How we apply it
Be specific, not vague	Name the group rather than reaching for “diverse communities”.
Person-first unless told otherwise	“Person with a disability”, unless someone prefers identity-first language such as “disabled person”.
Avoid assumptions	Do not assume marital status, family structure, health status or background in copy.
Centre the reader, not us	Write for the audience's needs and experience rather than only what we want to say.

4. Representing people

Inclusive communication is not only about words.

Our imagery

- **Reflects difference** in race, age, body size, disability, gender expression and background. As a matter of course, not as a special feature.
- **Shows people doing the work.** Where we picture our operation, we picture the people who make things, not only the products.
- **Is sourced from our own photography of our workspace and our work, and from commissioned photographers. We do not use stock imagery to represent our people, our workplace or our products.**
- **Excludes AI-generated people. Where we picture a person, that person exists and consented. We do not use synthetic imagery to represent diversity. An image of someone who does not exist is the opposite of representation.**

We avoid imagery that

- uses people as decoration, or includes someone solely to signal diversity;
- relies on stereotype. In role, setting, ability or family structure;
- shows a person in a way they have not agreed to; or

- depicts our workplace in a way that is staged rather than true.

Consent

We obtain written permission before publishing a photograph of a worker, a client's team or a supplier, and we honour a later request to withdraw it. Consent for one use is not consent for every use.

Checklist

- Every image of a person is one we made or commissioned, with that person's consent
- Visual content includes alt text for screen readers
- Colour contrast is considered in designed materials
- Captions and videos include subtitles where possible

5. Accessibility

Accessibility is about ensuring everyone can engage with our content, regardless of ability, device or context.

Area	Our approach
Plain language	We write at a reading age accessible to our audience, with no unnecessary jargon.
Document formatting	Clear headings, readable fonts, good colour contrast and consistent layouts.
Digital accessibility	Alt text where needed, accessible links and PDFs, and consideration of screen reader and keyboard navigation.
Events and meetings	We ask about access needs in advance and make reasonable adjustments.
Translation	Where relevant we provide translated content or plain English summaries.

6. External and published content

This section applies to anything published or sent outside the company. Our website, social media, marketing, proposals and client-facing material.

Claims

Factual, environmental, social and sourcing claims are governed by our **Responsible Marketing & Communications Principles**, not by this guide. The rule there is that no claim is published before the thing claimed is true and the evidence for it is held. Where the two documents appear to differ on a claim, that document applies.

Ethical content

- **We do not trade on fear.** We do not market by implying harm from ingredients, bodies or ways of living.
- **We do not use people's stories without permission,** including those of workers, clients and founders we back. Where we tell someone's story, they see it before it is published and may decline.
- **We do not borrow cultural reference we have no relationship to,** in naming, fragrance description or imagery.
- **We do not describe an intention as an achievement.** An ambition is written as an ambition, with a date.
- **We do not claim our clients' achievements as our own.**

Artificial intelligence

We use AI as a tool to support human work rather than replace it. All AI-assisted content is reviewed, validated and approved by a person before it is published. We are transparent about its use, we check output for bias and stereotype, we respect intellectual property and privacy, and we fact-check for accuracy. AI does not sign anything, and it does not speak for us.

Accessibility of published content

Everything we publish meets the standards in Section 5. Where a published document cannot be made accessible, we provide an accessible alternative on request at no cost.

7. When we get it wrong

No guide is perfect and language changes. What matters is how we respond.

1. **Listen.** Acknowledge the concern and review the language or content with openness.
2. **Correct it** in the content where possible, in the same place and with the same prominence as the original.
3. **Update this guide** so that the whole team learns from it.
4. **Thank the person who raised it.** Anyone can raise a concern about our communications through our grievance procedure at praxisbrands.co.uk/grievance, including anonymously, without any detriment for doing so.

The person responsible for updating this guide is Boyowa Olugbo, Director, with input from the wider team. **We review it every 12 months**, or sooner if feedback, team learning or changes in language make an update necessary.

8. How this guide is shared

This guide only works if it reaches the people writing, designing and photographing on our behalf. Which is not the same group as our payroll.

- Workers receive it at induction, and it sits in the Policies folder of our shared Google Drive where every worker can open it at any time without asking.
- Freelancers, agencies, photographers and PR representatives are sent it in writing before work begins, and agree to work to it as a condition of the engagement. Their output is our content.
- Anyone briefing external work attaches this guide to the brief, rather than assuming it is known.
- Each version carries a number and a date. When it changes we tell people what changed rather than replacing the file silently.

This guide is a living document. It supports the Justice, Equity, Diversity & Inclusion impact topic under B Lab's V2 standards, covering both the internal and the external communications sub-requirements.